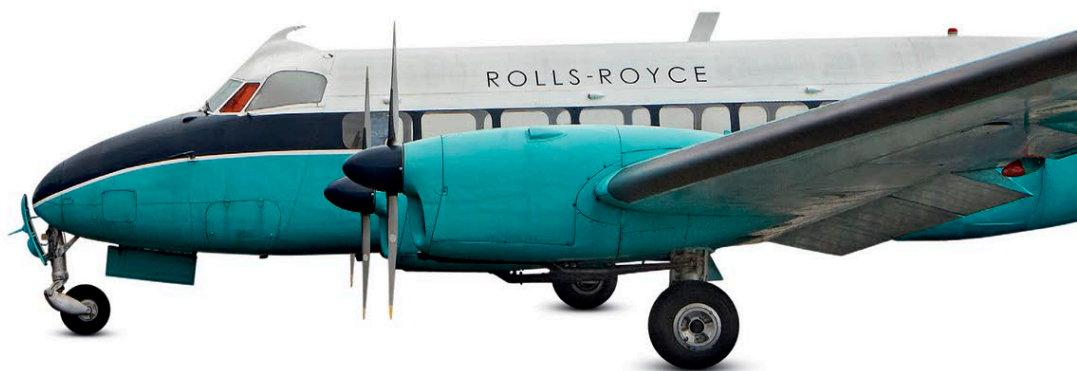


The End of Piston-engined Transport

By the late 1940s air travel was relatively safe and comfortable, with many airlines offering a regular and reliable transatlantic service. However, the piston-engine had peaked, with engines such as the Pratt & Whitney Wasp Major that had 28 cylinders and 56 spark plugs. Although powerful and reasonably reliable, these very complicated motors required a lot of maintenance, and the introduction of the turbojet and turboprop completely eclipsed them.



△ de Havilland DH114 Heron 1950

Origin UK

Engine 4 x 250 hp de Havilland Gipsy Queen 30 Mk2 air-cooled 6-cylinder inverted inline

Top speed 183 mph (294 km/h)

Descended from the earlier Dove, the Heron is notable for having four engines on a relatively small airframe. Despite this, the aircraft was still relatively slow, although it was structurally sound. Consequently, many were later fitted with more powerful American engines, including PT-6 turboprops.



△ Fairchild C-119G Flying Boxcar 1950

Origin USA

Engine 2 x 3,500 hp Pratt & Whitney Wasp Major air-cooled 28-cylinder 4-row radial

Top speed 296 mph (476 km/h)

Fairchild's previous design for a tactical transport, the C-82 was not very successful. However, Fairchild learned from its mistakes and the C-119 addressed all of the C-82's failures successfully. Almost 1,200 were produced, and the aircraft saw active service in many conflicts, including Korea and Vietnam.



△ Boeing C-97G Stratofreighter 1950

Origin USA

Engine 4 x 3,500 hp Pratt & Whitney Wasp Major air-cooled 28-cylinder 4-row radial

Top speed 375 mph (603 km/h)

Based on the B-50 bomber, the Stratofreighter's introduction to service coincided with the USAF making aerial refueling top priority because its first generation jet fighters and bombers all had very short range and endurance. Consequently, of the 888 C-97s built, only 60 were Stratofreighters, with the majority being tankers.



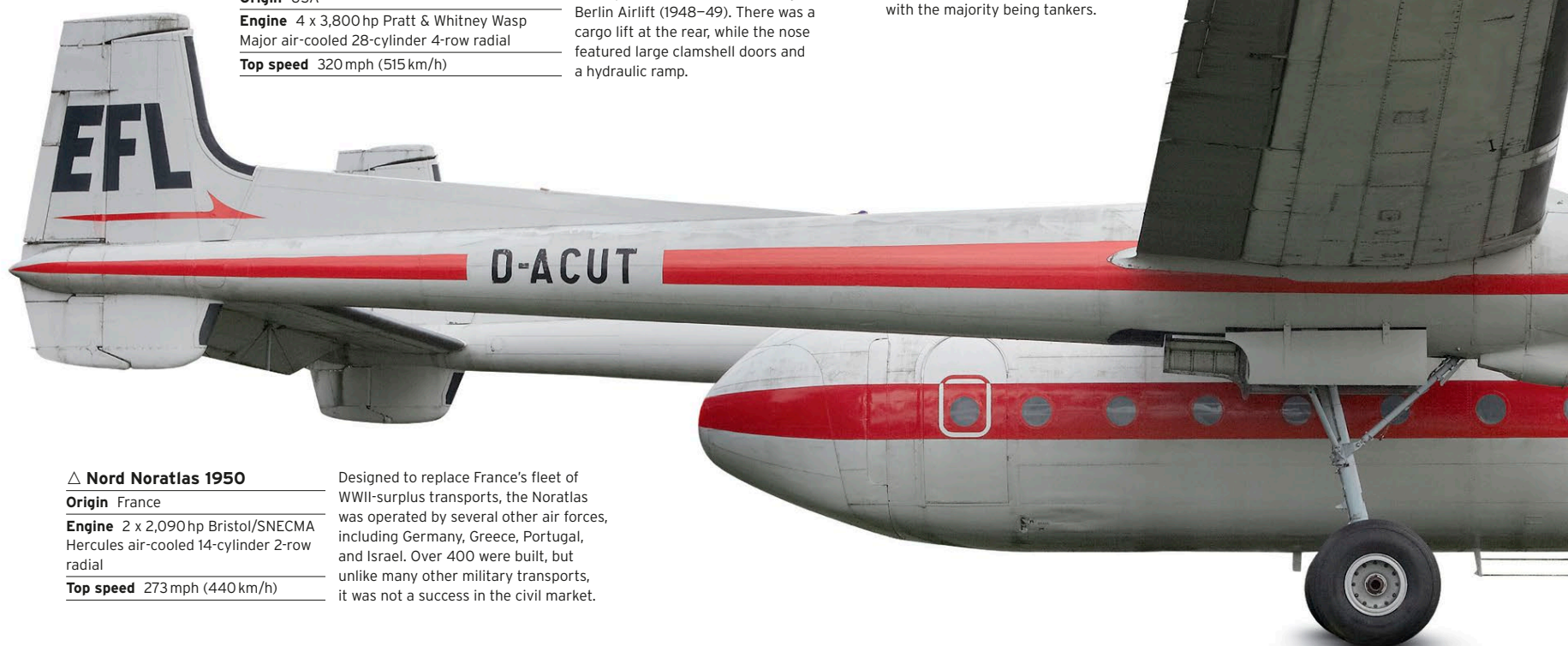
△ Douglas C-124C Globemaster II 1950

Origin USA

Engine 4 x 3,800 hp Pratt & Whitney Wasp Major air-cooled 28-cylinder 4-row radial

Top speed 320 mph (515 km/h)

The design of the Globemaster drew heavily on lessons learned during the Berlin Airlift (1948–49). There was a cargo lift at the rear, while the nose featured large clamshell doors and a hydraulic ramp.



△ Nord Noratlas 1950

Origin France

Engine 2 x 2,090 hp Bristol/SNECMA Hercules air-cooled 14-cylinder 2-row radial

Top speed 273 mph (440 km/h)

Designed to replace France's fleet of WWII-surplus transports, the Noratlas was operated by several other air forces, including Germany, Greece, Portugal, and Israel. Over 400 were built, but unlike many other military transports, it was not a success in the civil market.